

PUBLIC SUBMISSION

As of: March 21, 2025
Received: March 15, 2025
Status: [REDACTED]
Tracking No. m8a-3c5q-7oqf
Comments Due: March 15, 2025
Submission Type: API

Docket: NSF_FRDOC_0001
Recently Posted NSF Rules and Notices.

Comment On: NSF_FRDOC_0001-3479
Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

Document: NSF_FRDOC_0001-DRAFT-1767
Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

Submitter Information

Email: [REDACTED]
Organization: AI Literacy Foundation

General Comment

See attached file(s)

Attachments

AILiteracy response to Ostp NsfRfi notice request



To: Faisal D'Souza,

National Coordination Office (NCO),

Office of Science and Technology Policy.

From: Timi Olagunju, Esq.,

ED, AI Literacy Foundation

Subject: Response to RFI on the Development of an AI Action Plan

March 14, 2025

Introduction: AI Literacy as a Pillar for Global AI Leadership

The AI Literacy Foundation appreciates the opportunity to provide input on the development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan. As the United States charts its course toward maintaining AI leadership, it is crucial to recognize that AI literacy, both domestically and globally, plays a fundamental role in ensuring democratic AI adoption, economic growth, and national security.

While much of the current AI discourse has focused on export controls and strategic competition, history has shown that true leadership is not solely about restriction but also about strategic engagement, capacity building, and fostering inclusive AI adoption globally. The Global South, home to over 60% of the world's youth population, presents an opportunity for U.S. AI leadership, economic expansion, and democratic influence.

We submit this memo to urge the integration of AI literacy initiatives, global AI engagement, and structured AI cooperation with the Global South as part of the U.S. AI Action Plan as this is also

important to avoid leaving it out to other players such as China to dominate it due to US restrictive policies.

A Case for AI Literacy

1. It is important for the plan to recognize AI literacy as a strategic national asset, much like STEM education was during the Space Race. If the U.S. is to lead AI innovation and governance globally, it must ensure that AI is understood, trusted, and accessible, both within its borders and in emerging AI markets such as Africa, Latin America, and Southeast Asia. A digitally literate and AI-informed global workforce will shape AI adoption trends. Countries that lack AI education and literacy will default to AI models built by nations that actively engage them, potentially tilting AI influence toward authoritarian regimes.
2. Failure to engage the Global South in AI capacity-building risks ceding ground to China. The Belt and Road Initiative (BRI) has extended China's technological reach into Africa, Latin America, and parts of Europe. The U.S. must not allow the same to happen in AI. A US-centered AI-literate in the Global South ensures the preference for democratic AI principles, open innovation, and U.S.-aligned AI ecosystems.
3. AI misinformation, cybersecurity threats, and deepfake manipulation pose growing risks to democratic societies. Equipping citizens, both in the U.S. and allied nations, with AI literacy enhances resilience against AI-enabled disinformation and ensures alignment with U.S. security interests.

A robust AI literacy framework helps mitigate AI skill gaps that could lead to reliance on foreign AI systems for critical infrastructure. By investing in AI literacy, the U.S. fortifies its workforce and reduces reliance on adversarial AI models.

The Role of the Global South in U.S. AI Leadership

1. AI literacy presents an unparalleled opportunity for the U.S. to exert soft power, countering China's AI expansionism through educational partnerships, technology exchange programs, and AI research hubs. By integrating AI training programs, scholarships, and AI capacity-building initiatives into foreign policy efforts, the U.S. can cement its AI leadership for generations.
2. The Global South is not only a consumer market for AI but a future contributor to AI innovation, particularly in areas such as agriculture, health tech, and financial inclusion. This offers an early opportunity for U.S. AI partnership driven by a private-public sector to be actively incorporated into the Global South as an AI collaborator rather than an afterthought. Africa, home to the world's fastest-growing youth population, is poised to be a global AI powerhouse if investments in AI education and literacy are prioritized. Engagement today means influence for US tomorrow.

Recommended Policies for the AI Action Plan

1. The Plan needs to establish a National AI Literacy Framework to integrate AI education at all levels - from K-12 to workforce reskilling programs.
2. Partner with US-based universities, industry leaders, and research institutions to develop US centric AI literacy programs for non-technical stakeholders, including policymakers, journalists, and business leaders in Global South.
3. Launch Global AI Literacy Initiatives targeting the Global South to counteract China's AI dominance and promote ethical AI adoption aligned with U.S. values.
4. Establish AI knowledge-sharing partnerships with governments, universities, and tech hubs across Africa, Latin America, and Asia. Also, incentivize U.S. AI firms to provide AI

training, internships, and AI-based entrepreneurship support to emerging markets, ensuring democratic AI adoption.

5. Integrate AI literacy into national security strategy to combat deepfake misinformation, cyber threats, and algorithmic manipulation.
6. Mandate AI awareness and risk education for public officials, election bodies, and perhaps media organizations to safeguard democratic institutions.
7. Expand visa and research exchange programs for AI scholars from the Global South, strengthening U.S. academic AI dominance. Establish a Global AI Training Fund, providing AI skills development for underrepresented communities and ensuring AI innovation reflects diverse perspectives.

Conclusion: A Future-Proofed AI Strategy for the U.S.

The U.S. must recognize that AI leadership is not just about developing the best models or regulations that ban models or platforms, but ensuring the world understands, trusts, and aligns with them. AI literacy, both at home and abroad, is not an optional add-on, it is a foundational pillar for sustaining U.S. economic, technological, and geopolitical leadership. We urge the Office of Science and Technology Policy to integrate AI literacy initiatives and strategic AI engagement with the Global South into the AI Action Plan.

Timi Olagunju, Esq.

ED, AI Literacy Foundation

www.AILiteracy.foundation

